FINANCE – ALL PROGRAMS

Cash & Check Handling Procedure

For any cash or check received at any program or event: two people, written down, in the bank fast.

Maa's Inspiration Inc. · 2700 Old Denton Rd, Suite 102, Carrollton, TX 75007 · (469) 270-8156

Who does what

No one person handles a gift from start to finish. The person who records or reconciles is never the only person who counted or deposited.

Role	Name	Backup
Counter 1 (opens the cash box or mail)	Aslam Hemani	
Counter 2 (counts with Counter 1)	TBD	
Depositor (takes the deposit to the bank)	Aslam Hemani	
Recorder (enters the Interim Ledger)		
Reconciler (monthly check; not the depositor)		
Acknowledgment signer (signs donor thank-yous and receipts)	Aslam Hemani	
Approver (approves expenses)		
Bank and branch for deposits	Guarantee Bank	Branch: TBD

The 10 rules

1. **Two people, always.** Cash and checks are opened and counted by **two people together**. Both sign the count sheet.
2. **Write a receipt** from the numbered receipt book for every cash gift or payment, and whenever asked. Keep the copy.
3. **Endorse checks right away:** stamp the back “For deposit only – Maa's Inspiration Inc.” Never cash a check.
4. **Log it:** every item goes on the **Deposit Log** (page 3) with the count sheet total.
5. **Lock it up** in the locked cash box, in a locked place, until it is deposited.
6. **Deposit within 2 business days.** The depositor keeps the bank receipt and gives it to the recorder.
7. **No cash at home**, in a car overnight, or in a personal account. No borrowing or making change from your own money.
8. **Do not pay bills from cash.** Expenses are paid from the organization's account, approved, with a receipt.
9. **Record it** in the Interim Ledger (Income and Deposits tabs) within 2 business days, tagged with the program.
10. **Count does not match?** Never cover it with your own money. Write the difference on the count sheet and tell the approver the same day.

Card gifts (Stripe), reconciliation and thank-you letters

Stripe (online card gifts) – each month

- ☐ Download the Stripe **payouts report** for the month.
- ☐ Match each **Stripe payout** to a bank deposit. Stripe pays out the **net** amount; record the **gross gift** as income and the **Stripe fee** as an expense.
- ☐ Check every gift in Stripe is in the **Income** tab (program tag, donor, date).
- ☐ Note refunds and disputes. Ask the approver about anything you cannot match.

Monthly reconciliation (by the 10th of the next month)

- ☐ The **reconciler** (not the depositor) compares the bank statement to the **Deposits** tab, the Stripe payouts and the **Expenses** tab.
- ☐ Every deposit has a count sheet and a bank receipt. Every expense has a receipt and an approval.
- ☐ The **Monthly Summary** tab shows income and expenses by program. Differences are explained in writing.
- ☐ The reconciler and the approver sign and date the month (bottom of this page).

Donor thank-you and acknowledgment letters

- Use the **Donor Acknowledgment Letter Templates** (Batch 2, doc 03). Every letter shows **Maa's Inspiration Inc., 501(c)(3), EIN 86-2221897**.
- **Gifts of $250 or more** need a written acknowledgment (IRC §170(f)(8)), stating the amount and whether anything was given in return. We aim to thank **every** donor **within 48 hours**.
- **Payments over $75** where the donor gets something (a dinner, an event ticket): use Letter B with a **good-faith value** of what they received (IRC §6115).
- A Stripe email receipt alone is **not enough** for $250+ gifts. Send the letter too.
- Record the date the letter was sent in the Income tab (column “Ack sent”). Year-end statements go out by **January 31**.
- Non-cash gifts (food, supplies): describe the item, but **do not put a dollar value** on it. That is the donor's job.

Keep the records

Keep count sheets, deposit slips, bank receipts, receipt-book copies, Stripe reports and letters for **7 years** (Board Policy Pack, record retention). Keep donor details private.

Month reconciled: _____ **Reconciler – signature / date: _____**

Approver – signature / date: _____ **Differences? Y / N _____**

► Needs a decision (Aslam / attorney)

Aslam Hemani handles all cash and checks (Counter 1 and depositor). Bank: Guarantee Bank. Still to name: the second counter (TBD; the two-person count stays), the backups, the recorder, the reconciler (must not be the depositor, so not Aslam), the approver, the branch. Aslam Hemani signs donor thank-yous and receipts. CPA to check the Stripe fee treatment and the acknowledgment wording before first use.

Count Sheet and Deposit Log

Count sheet (two people)

Date: _____ Event / program: _____ Receipt #s used: _____

Cash	Count	Amount	Checks	Check # / from	Amount
$100			1		
$50			2		
$20			3		
$10			4		
$5 / $1			5		
Coins			6		
Cash total			**Checks total**		

Grand total (cash + checks): $ _____ Program tag: _____

_____ _____ _____

Counter 1 – signature | Printed name | Date

_____ _____ _____

Counter 2 – signature | Printed name | Date

Deposit log

Date counted	Cash $	Checks $	Total $	Deposited (date)	By	Bank receipt ✓	Ledger ✓

Approval and review

Approved by (name / title): _____ Date: _____

Attorney review (name / date): _____ Next review: _____